

## Memjet printing

Memjet printing is a new technology, using a stationary print head with 70,000 microscopic nozzles, thus printing rapidly

## Epson Stylus Photo R3000

Epson announced a new A3+ inkjet printer - the R3000 - which supports Wi-Fi connectivity

**MFD Test**

# Do more than just print

Multi-functional devices are slowly but surely replacing stand-alone printers due to their versatility. We tell you why...

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Back in the day, a printer purchase was a major decision, as it cost a bomb. Only the very ambitious ones went for the colour printers, whereas mere mortals had to make do with mono-chrome printers. And who can forget that buzzing sound of the dot matrix printers? All that is in the past.

Fast forward to today, where printing is just one of the many features on offer. Multi-functional devices (MFD hereon) offer printing, scanning and copying on the same device, with many of them also adding PictBridge support, Wi-Fi support and memory card slots so that you don't even have to power on your PC to get a print. With the web functionality (and we don't just mean Wi-Fi support) added to the multi-functional devices, this category has also entered the league of convergence devices.

We got around seven MFDs to test, from brands such as Canon, HP, Epson and Brother. We also received MFDs from brands such as Samsung and Ricoh, but since they were way above our set price barrier, we could not include them in the shootout. Do look out for their reviews in the coming month though.

## Features

### Epson ME Office 960FWD and ME 620F

Office 960FWD comes in the traditional Epson all black body. This colour inkjet multi-function device comes with a 2.5-inch LCD screen bang in the middle of the operational panel, which is neatly divided into four sections: Photo, Scan, Fax and Copy. The operational panel is tilt adjustable making it easier to use while you are in a sitting position or standing.

The 960FWD supports Wi-Fi and the instruction manual explains the Wi-Fi setup procedure brilliantly. Although the nomenclature says Office, it has some features such as an SD card slot and PictBridge connectivity that will appeal to the home user.

The Epson ME 620F looks similar to the 960FWD, but is more bulky and has a two-line LCD display as opposed to the 2.5-inch colour LCD found on the 960FWD. There is no backlight on the display that makes it difficult to view in the dark.

While the 620F has no network connectivity options, the 960FWD comes with ethernet and Wi-Fi connectivity. The 960FWD also supports duplex printing.

### Canon PIXMA MP287 and PIXMA MP497

Canon sent us their basic MFDs from the PIXMA range, namely MP287 and MP497. Both the MFDs are identical in all aspects, except the fact that the MP497 has an in-built Wi-Fi support. Both of them come in the standard MP series form factor, comprising a glossy black body with rounded edges. Surprisingly, none of the MFDs sported a PictBridge connect or a memory card slot. The paper loading tray is located on the rear side of the printer and they both have a flatbed scanner which forms the top portion of the device. They house two cartridges: colour and black.

On the right hand side of the MFD you have the operational panel which is

the same for both MP287 and MP497. It comprises a single digit LCD screen which allows you to select number of pages to print among other things. A single button below the display, can help you select between paper type and size. There are three status indicators for paper jam and ink running low.

Canon's bundled software, Canon Solutions, when activated arranges itself in the form of bubbles on the right hand side of your screen and allows you to select the specific functionality.



### HP PhotoSmart Premium C310a



Epson ME Office 960FWD was awarded the Best Buy

This is one smart MFD from HP aptly titled PhotoSmart. The C310a apart from having the regular print, copy and scan functionalities, also includes a new one - Web. Not only does it support

Wi-Fi and have network connectivity, but it supports cloud printing. Once you register the printer on HP's ePrint web site, you can send an email to a unique ID associated with the printer from anywhere and get a print.

The C310a is very sturdy, with a piano black glossy body. The HP C310a lacks an automatic document feeder. It sports a 4.3-inch touchscreen. There are no buttons on this MFD, apart from the power button. All other operations are touch controlled. The main screen is divided into three sections: one showing functions such as Print, Scan and Copy; the other showing various applications supported which require an internet connection. The third one on top shows the status indicators. At present in India, there is a limited app support for Google Docs, Tabbloid, Sudoku, Quick Forms, Yahoo! News and DreamWorks. Quick Forms comprises forms such as notebook paper, puzzles, and calendar. The apps